Ishwarya Chengalvarayan

Senior DevOps & Cloud Security Engineer | Solutions Engineering

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Portfolio · GitHub · LinkedIn

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior DevOps and Cloud Security Engineer with 7+ years designing, automating, and securing enterprise-scale AWS infrastructure. Deep hands-on background in Zero Trust architecture, IAM, ZTNA platforms, and cloud security policy enforcement across large-scale Kubernetes and multi-cloud environments. Experienced in authoring RFCs and architecture design documents, leading infrastructure modernisation, and presenting technical strategy to engineering and senior leadership teams. Public portfolio includes live architecture demonstrations, GitHub repositories, and customer-style technical presentations covering AWS infrastructure and cost intelligence, identity and access decision design, and SE discovery and solution design.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Cloud Security Architecture | Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA) | IAM, RBAC, SCIM, SSO/SAML, OIDC, OAuth2 | SAST/DAST | Least-Privilege & Policy-as-Code
- RFC & Architecture Design Document Authorship | Multi-Region Cloud Infrastructure | Cloud Migration Strategy | AWS Well-Architected Framework
- Technical Advisory | Customer-Facing Solution Design | Stakeholder Alignment | Translating Technical Tradeoffs into Business Impact
- IaC & Platform Engineering (Terraform, Spacelift) | Monorepo & Blessed Module Frameworks | CI/CD & GitOps | Cost Optimisation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer · Bugcrowd

· April 2026 – Present · Remote

- Contributing to Monorepo architecture scoping across 100+ repositories in a security-focused bug bounty platform, defining service boilerplate standards and reducing onboarding friction for new services.
- Establishing IaC guardrails and CI/CD pipeline standards across a security-sensitive codebase with compliance and auditability requirements.

Infrastructure Architect (Contract) · Mercor AI Lab

· 2026 · Remote

- Designed the cloud platform architecture for a distributed AI lab deploying LLM inference workloads: authored the platform RFC and architecture design documents covering approach rationale, risk analysis, and phased rollout.
- Implemented a tiered Terraform-blessed modules library (S3, IAM, ECS, Lambda, EventBridge) designed for LLM workload deployments, with a Spacelift-driven ClickOps-free pipeline enforcing audit trails across all Monorepo projects.
- Presented architecture decisions and led async design reviews with US and Australian engineering leads, translating infrastructure trade-offs into business-level recommendations across time zones.

Career Break — Southeast Asia ·

August 2025 – February 2026

Planned sabbatical following 7 years of continuous employment. Travelled independently across Southeast Asia; trained in Mixed Martial Arts (MMA).

Software Engineer · Cisco Systems

· September 2023 – July 2025 · Bengaluru

- Designed secure, scalable cloud architecture supporting 2M+ monthly transactions, improving deployment efficiency by 30% through policy enforcement guardrails and RBAC-aligned access models.
- Managed multi-region AWS infrastructure with Terraform, leading expansion into China and US Gov regions. Coordinated cross-functional stakeholder discussions across security, compliance, and engineering to align architecture with FedRAMP and regional data governance requirements.
- Evaluated SaaS ZTNA platforms (Cloudflare Zero Trust, Netskope, and Palo Alto) against identity integration, policy enforcement, and SCIM requirements; translated trade-offs into a structured comparison for senior engineering leadership.
- Implemented SAST and DAST pipelines (SonarQube, CodeQL) across 50+ repositories covering Java, Go, and Python services, embedding automated security scanning into CI/CD workflows and reducing dependency exposure.
- Delivered 20% compute cost reduction via AWS Well-Architected cost pillar analysis; led AppDynamics migration, reducing monitoring overhead by ~40%.
- Integrated Dynatrace Davis AI and Datadog Watchdog for proactive anomaly detection and executive-grade audit reporting across a 1,000+ EKS cluster environment.

Senior DevOps Engineer · Reshamandi

· May 2023 – July 2023 · Bengaluru

- Led EKS-to-AKS cloud migration and Jenkins-to-Kubernetes codebase transition, reducing deployment cycles by 30% through Terraform IaC automation.

Senior DevOps Engineer · Gale Partners

· May 2022 – April 2023 · Bengaluru

- Engineered ArgoCD-based GitOps infrastructure across 3 AWS regions with RBAC guardrails and self-serve CI/CD pipelines, reducing manual errors by 80%.

- Led OpenShift 3→4 enterprise migration with zero downtime, conducting solution alignment sessions with platform teams to map current-state requirements before re-architecture; reduced service downtime by 25% through Istio service mesh redesign.
- Terraform multi-tenant restructuring: 20 customer environments co-located in a single repository — conducted technical discovery, authored the RFC, and led implementation into fully isolated per-customer state with zero cross-client blast radius.

Senior DevOps Engineer · **Qburst Technologies** · July 2021 – May 2022 · Chennai

- Built AWS infrastructure from scratch for Android, iOS, and web products (Cognito, API Gateway, Lambda, CloudFront, Route 53), improving delivery latency by 40%.
- Managed Kubernetes workloads, achieving 50% scalability growth and 30% downtime reduction; secured multi-region clusters via VPC segmentation and IAM access controls.

Systems Engineer · **Sify Technologies** · July 2018 – July 2021 · Chennai

- Supported 200 Linux enterprise clients on VMware, AWS, and Azure; automated operations with Python, Shell, and Ansible to achieve 99.9% uptime and 35% reliability improvement.
- Led on-premises to AWS cloud migration, reducing provisioning time by 60%; integrated Azure AD and Google Identity for enterprise authentication flows.

PUBLIC PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

AWS Infrastructure & Cost Intelligence Copilot

Platform teams lack a single place to ask plain-English questions about AWS findings, cost anomalies, and account risk. Natural language interface grounded in live AWS data, built on Bedrock and pgvector retrieval over real collected findings. Live Demo GitHub Engineering Notes

Identity & Access Decision Studio

Real-time policy evaluation engine integrated with live Okta SSO, covering identity, device posture, and blast-radius impact analysis before rollout. Access policy decisions are no longer opaque Live Demo GitHub Engineering Notes

SE Discovery & Solution Design Copilot

Adaptive discovery engine that surfaces underlying gaps, scores them against compliance frameworks, and generates architecture tradeoff options — built to demonstrate technical discovery thinking. Live Demo GitHub Engineering Notes

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cloud Platforms: AWS (primary), Azure (intermediate), GCP (familiar) | AWS Well-Architected Framework
- IaC & Platform Engineering: Terraform, Terragrunt, Ansible, CloudFormation, Spacelift, Monorepo architecture, blessed modules
- Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, EKS, AKS, Helm, OpenShift, ECS Fargate
- CI/CD & GitOps: Jenkins, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD, Spinnaker
- Security & Identity: AWS IAM, GuardDuty, AWS Config, Inspector, ZTNA (Cloudflare, Netskope, Palo Alto), Okta, Azure AD, Ping Identity, ADFS, SSO/SAML, SCIM, OIDC, OAuth2, RBAC, CIS Benchmarks, VPC Security, SAST/DAST (SonarQube, CodeQL)
- Observability: CloudWatch, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Dynatrace, Datadog, AppDynamics
- Programming & Scripting: Python, Shell/Bash, PowerShell, YAML, Groovy
- AI & Automation: n8n, OpenRouter (Mistral, Llama 3, Qwen), OpenAI API, LLM orchestration, Webhook/REST integration
- Cost Management: AWS Budgets, Cost Explorer, CloudHealth, Spot.io

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology, Information Technology · Anna University, Chennai · 2014–2018 · GPA 8.47 / 10.0

Published: *Detection of Network Layer Attacks in MANET — Intrusion Detection Using Grammatical Evolution and Feature Selection*

Languages: English (fluent) · Tamil (native) · Hindi (conversational) Right to work: Work sponsorship Required. EMEA / Singapore considered.